

This writing seeks to explain the golden thread that has embedded my life, so that you may understand where I have come from, where I am going, and therefore, who I am.

For most of my life, I did not know what I wanted to spend my life doing. I do not mean this in a casual way. I mean that I spent years genuinely searching for the thing that could hold my attention, my curiosity, my effort, and my pride for the rest of my life.

Because of this, my life has not followed a straight line. I went from studying music, to the army, to pre-med, to hospitality and becoming a sommelier, to web development, to trading, to psychology, to Brazilian Jiu Jitsu instructor and competitor, to philosophy, to physics, and now to data science and AI/ML engineering.

At first glance, this looks scattered. For a long time, it felt scattered. But looking back, I can see that I was not randomly moving between unrelated fields. I was circling the same problem from different angles. I wanted to understand how the world works, how people work, how systems work, and what can actually be known with enough confidence to act on. That question eventually led me into philosophy. Philosophy gave me the language to ask the questions I had been carrying for years, but it also forced me into a crisis. In my final year of undergraduate studies, while reading Wittgenstein and learning more about the current landscape of academic metaphysics, I became increasingly convinced that truth cannot float freely away from the physical world. For me, claims about reality needed to make contact with evidence, measurement, and empirical support.

This conclusion upended the direction I thought I was going. I had been interested in metaphysics, but I found myself losing faith in claims that could not be grounded in the world somehow. So I moved toward the philosophical foundations of physics instead. Physics still had the depth, abstraction, and conceptual difficulty that I loved, but it also had something philosophy often lacked for me: contact with experiment. Especially in quantum mechanics, I found a field where the deepest conceptual questions were still tied to mathematical structure and empirical results.

At that point, I thought my path was becoming clear. I was preparing to pursue a PhD in the philosophical foundations of physics. Then LLMs arrived in a serious way, and something changed.

AI sparked an excitement in me that I had not felt before. It had the abstraction of philosophy, the mathematical structure of physics, the empirical discipline of science, and the practical force of engineering. It was not just a topic to think about. It was something I could build, test, train, deploy, measure, and improve. It felt like a place where all the strange pieces of my background could finally converge.

So I changed direction immediately. I applied to schools in the United States because I believed this was where the future of AI and machine learning was being built. I accepted a Master's program in Data Science at Seattle University because I wanted to stay close to my family if possible, as I am from Vancouver, Canada, and because I wanted a place where I could build the technical foundation I needed.

Since then, I have treated my coursework as the floor, not the ceiling. Alongside my classes, I have been squeezing every extra amount of brain power and time I have into learning AI, machine learning, systems, and applied data science. This is what led me to the extra project work in my github. I built those projects not because I had to, but because I could not get enough of the field.

The areas I keep gravitating toward are knowledge distillation, interpretability, systems, low-level engineering, and the mathematical basis for why deep learning works. I cannot fully explain why these areas pull me so strongly, other than that this is where my curiosity keeps taking me. I love moving from abstraction to implementation: from an idea, to code, to a trained model, to a working system, to something that can be evaluated and improved. This is also why I do not see data science or AI/ML as just a career pivot. It is the first field I have found that feels large enough for the kind of curiosity I have always had. It lets me think deeply, build practically, learn continuously, and work on problems that matter.

I explain all of this to show that this path is not casual for me. There is nothing else I want to be doing. I spend every minute I can learning and improving. And when I take breaks, those breaks are in service of coming back to the work with a clearer mind. That is why I take my health and habits seriously: hiking with my dogs in the forest, spending time with loved ones, exercising regularly, eating good food with good people, and doing Brazilian Jiu Jitsu. These things keep me grounded enough to keep pushing.

I also understand that my path has not been traditional. I have lived a strange and nonlinear life, and because of that, I did not spend the earliest part of my career building technical skills in the same straight line as others. But I do not see that only as a weakness. That path gave me range, discipline, psychological depth, philosophical clarity, and the ability to connect ideas across fields that often remain separate.

So what I bring to the table is not only technical ability, but a deep commitment to learning until I understand something properly. I also bring loyalty, consistency, dependability, and a genuine passion for building useful systems and understanding the world through them.

The main problem I have been wrestling with since I was a teenager was whether I could find work that I would be proud to devote my life to. After searching for more than 15 years, I can honestly say that I have found it.

So if given the opportunity, I can honestly say this: you will have a hard time finding someone more excited to be at work.

Thanks for reading. I hope you enjoyed it, and I hope you gathered a better sense of who I am.